

Computer Essentials

Course Outline

Duration:	2 Weeks
Certification:	ICDL Foundation
Level:	Foundation
Format:	Theory + Hands-on Practical Sessions

WEEK 1: Computers and Devices

Day 1: Introduction to Hardware

Theory Topics

- Types of computers: desktops, laptops, all-in-one computers
- Mobile devices: tablets and smartphones
- Key hardware components: CPU, RAM, storage, motherboard

Practical Lesson

- Identify and label parts of a desktop computer
- Compare specifications of different devices (desktop vs laptop vs tablet)
- Open a computer case and identify internal components

Day 2: Ports and Peripherals

Theory Topics

- Common ports: USB (Type-A, Type-C), HDMI, VGA, Audio jack
- Wireless connectivity: Bluetooth and Wi-Fi
- Input devices: keyboard, mouse, scanner, microphone
- Output devices: monitor, printer, speakers

Practical Lesson

- Connect and configure a printer (wired and wireless)
- Set up Bluetooth pairing between devices
- Connect external monitor using HDMI and VGA cables
- Use a scanner to digitize a document

Day 3: Operating Systems

Theory Topics

- What is an operating system and its functions
- Common operating systems: Windows, macOS, Linux, Android, iOS
- Difference between operating systems and applications

Practical Lesson

- Navigate the Windows desktop environment
- Use the Start menu and taskbar effectively
- Access and explore system settings
- Check system information (RAM, processor, OS version)

Day 4: Device Operations

Theory Topics

- Proper startup and shutdown procedures
- Sleep, hibernate, and restart functions
- User accounts and login procedures
- Basic troubleshooting concepts

Practical Lesson

- Practice proper shutdown, restart, and sleep operations
- Create and manage user accounts
- Use Task Manager to view running processes
- Perform basic troubleshooting: frozen application, unresponsive system

Day 5: Week 1 Review and Assessment

Activities

- Review quiz on hardware and operating systems
- Practical assessment: Set up a complete workstation with peripherals
- Group activity: Troubleshoot common hardware issues

WEEK 2: Managing Files and Applications

Day 6: File Management Basics

Theory Topics

- Understanding file systems and hierarchical structures
- Common file types and their icons
- File extensions and associations
- Navigating with File Explorer/Finder

Practical Lesson

- Navigate through drives and folders using File Explorer
- Identify different file types by their icons and extensions
- Use address bar and navigation pane effectively
- Change folder view options (icons, list, details)

Day 7: Organizing Files and Folders

Theory Topics

- Creating and naming folders effectively
- Copy, move, and delete operations
- Using the Recycle Bin and restoring files
- Searching for files and using filters

Practical Lesson

- Create an organized folder structure for a project
- Practice copying, moving, and renaming files
- Delete files and restore from Recycle Bin
- Use search function with different criteria

Day 8: Storage Types and Management

Theory Topics

- Internal vs external storage devices
- USB flash drives and memory cards
- Introduction to cloud storage services
- Storage measurements: KB, MB, GB, TB, PB

Practical Lesson

- Connect and safely eject USB drives
- Transfer files between internal and external storage
- Check available storage space on different drives
- Set up and use a cloud storage account (Google Drive/OneDrive)

Day 9: Working with Applications

Theory Topics

- Installing applications from different sources
- Uninstalling applications properly
- Software updates and their importance
- Taking screenshots and screen capture

Practical Lesson

- Install an application from Microsoft Store
- Install a desktop application from a downloaded file
- Uninstall applications using Control Panel and Settings
- Use different screenshot methods: Print Screen, Snipping Tool, Win+Shift+S

Day 10: Final Review and Certification Prep

Activities

- Comprehensive review of all topics
- Written assessment covering theory concepts
- Practical exam: Complete file management tasks
- Course evaluation and feedback session
- Certificate distribution

Start Learning, Start Earning

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